

History

U.S. History
World History
Ancient History





About the Course

This course includes the following topic(s): U.S. History: Grades 7-8, Ancient History: Grades 7-9

About U.S. History: Grades 7-8

Read about U.S. history from 1800-1900 through books that immerse students in the time period and allow them to see the world through the eyes of those who lived it. Through engaging narratives, history spines, primary source documents, and books that show different perspectives, students come to see history as more than dates and events and develop relationships with people from the past. Viewing images, looking at maps, and working on one's Book of Centuries are also part of developing this relationship.

About World History: Grades 7-9

Read about U.S. and world history from 800-1650AD and ancient history from 3500-550BC through biographies, primary source documents, and history spines. View images and reference atlases and maps to set the people and events in their time and place. Update History Charts and Book of Centuries as appropriate for student level., Read about Canadian and world history from 800-1650AD and ancient history from 3500-550BC through biographies, primary source documents, and history spines. View images and reference atlases and maps to set the people and events in their time and place. Update History Charts and Book of Centuries as appropriate for student level., Read about U.S. and world history from 800-1650AD and ancient history from 3500-550BC through biographies, primary source documents, and history spines. View images and reference atlases and maps to set the people and events in their time and place. Update History Charts and Book of Centuries.

About Ancient History: Grades 7-9

Read about ancient history from 100 BC-350 AD through biographies, primary source documents, and history spines. Students will view images, reference maps, and update their Book of Centuries as part of the lessons.



Placement & Combining Tips

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

U.S. history may be suitable for 9th graders as well if combining.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
7-8	U.S. History: Grades 7-8 2 times/week 30 min	A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860 Abraham Lincoln and Frederick Douglass: The Story Behind and American Friendship A Year in the South: 1865 Sacajawea Gold Mountain
7-9	Ancient History: Grades 7-9 1 time/week 30 min	The Witness of Early Christian Women: Mothers of the Church A Short History of Ancient Rome Historical Atlas of the World 6th Ed.

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)				
	World History: Grades 7-8		Ancient History: Grades 7-9	



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

U.S. History: Grades 7-8



A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860



Abraham Lincoln and Frederick Douglass: The Story Behind and American Friendship



A Year in the South: 1865



Sacajawea



Gold Mountain

Ancient History: Grades 7-9



The Witness of Early Christian Women: Mothers of the Church



A Short History of Ancient Rome



Historical Atlas of the World 6th Ed.



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

- ∞ [Extra Helpings](#)
- ∞ [History Charts & Timelines Scope & Sample](#)
- ∞ [Century Chart](#)
- ∞ [Grade 7 U.S. History Chart Prompts](#)
- ∞ [Grade 8 U.S. History Chart Prompts](#)
- ∞ [Foundations \(See Section 15: History\)](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

How To Teach



Prepare

- Read through the lesson and gather any necessary links.
- If you have not read the book, you may want to read the selected pages in advance.
- Decide which lessons/books to read together and which to have students read independently.



Recap

- Connect back to the previous lesson. Have students give a summary of what they remember. (Full narration is not necessary.)
- If the previous passage is difficult to remember, teachers may ask a leading question: "What can you tell me about..." Or students may try looking back at any chapter/section headings or illustrations or reading the first paragraph to jog the memory.



Introduce

- Use a picture, map, or engaging question to pique the student's interest in the day's lesson (often included in lesson plans).
- If necessary, talk about a few unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

- Read the day's passage out loud or have the student read independently. Sometimes reading for the specified time is a better guide.
- If a book is challenging, try stopping to narrate every now and then rather than waiting until the end. It can also help to read aloud. Or you might want to use an audiobook version of the text and have students read along with it.
- Have students keep an eye out for events or characters to add to their Citizenship Notebook, Book of Centuries, or Copywork Book.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally or write a narration.
- Alternatively, students might analyze a character, trace cause to consequence, outline a passage, or use one of the other methods indicated by Charlotte Mason in School Education Chapter 16, especially p.180.
- Students who enjoy writing can experiment with different types of written narrations, but this is not required.



Discuss

- Give the student an opportunity to share thoughts on the lesson and any connections made (orally or in writing).

- You could ask them what they thought about the passage or ask an open-ended question to stimulate discussion. Discussion questions are often included in the lesson plans.



Connect

- Optional: Add something to the Book of Centuries, Century Chart, Citizenship Notebook, or Commonplace book. If students would like to include pictures, these may be drawn or printed.

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 1

Los Soldados, A Terrible Mistake

Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→ INTRO

This is a historical fiction book that takes place in 1835-1836. This genre of book allows you to walk in the shoes of the soldiers of Mexico who were forced to fight the Americans at the Battle of the Alamo. As you read, you will see Spanish terms in italics. You can find the meaning of those words at the back of the book.

→ LOCATE

∞ Map Link: Mexico

Find Guanajuato, which is located in central Mexico, about 130 miles northwest of Mexico City. How would you describe the terrain of this area?

Lorenzo lives in this village.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.1-14 "If someone sat" - "frown on her face."

- How would you describe Lorenzo so far?

→ VIEW

The predominant religion of Mexico is Roman Catholicism. Our Lady of Guadalupe holds a special place in the religious life of Mexico and is one of the most popular religious devotions. Her image, a woman of mixed Indigenous and European features wearing a turquoise-colored mantle surrounded by a sunburst, has played an important role as a national symbol of Mexico.

∞ Image Link: Virgin of Guadalupe

• DEFINITIONS

conscrip: (p.6) enrolled into service by compulsion : drafted

dragoon: (p.7) mounted soldiers that fought both on horseback and on foot

WEEK 1 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 1

The War of 1812

Materials: PDF Link

→ INTRO

1. This year you are studying the time period 1800-1900. The books we are reading begin in 1820. Today's lesson will highlight some significant events that happened before 1820, and we will begin the book next week. The American Revolution ended in 1783 with the signing of the Treaty of Paris, where the U.S. was acknowledged as a sovereign nation. In 1800, the U.S. population totaled 5.3 million, including one million African Americans, of whom 900,000 were enslaved.

2. Imagine what life was like in the U.S. in the early 1800's. Describe what you know about transportation, communication, food production, and clothing. Many important inventions were created during this time, and people's way of life changed due to the Industrial Revolution. Watch this video to learn more about this.

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Industrial Revolution (8:00)

- What inventions do you think were the most impactful for people at that time? What are some of the inventions you are most grateful for?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

This is a chapter from Joy Hakim's book A History of US, Volume 4.

∞ PDF Link: The War of 1812

• IMPORTANT DATES

War of 1812 between America and Britain

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 1

Meeting Sulla

Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ INTRO

This year, you are learning about ancient Rome. We are not starting at the beginning with the legend of Romulus and Remus in 753 B.C. We are jumping ahead to 88 BC. The Roman Republic has become a world power. It has marched through the Greek world, razed cities like Carthage, and unseated powerful people. As Pascal Hughes says, "The march of Rome appears unstoppable."

However, what had once been a republic, which had enabled certain people to vote in their leadership, was quickly becoming more of a dictatorship, which is where one person assumes absolute power. There were a number of factors that led to Sulla becoming the first dictator in the Roman Republic. He assumed power through political violence, manipulation of land and resources, and military coups. In 88 BC, the Republic found itself in danger.

Sulla's story doesn't start at the beginning of his dictatorship.

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

Ch.6 p.89-99 - end at "political violence tamed"

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.14-15.

Find Carthage, Rome, and any other cities that pop up in your reading to familiarize yourself with the world of Ancient Rome.

• STUDENT TIP

Be sure to add some people, events, and drawings of artifacts to your book of centuries. Mark potential items with a Post-it note as you read so you remember to find something when you sit down to work in your book.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Carthage is razed by Scipio

Aemilianus in 146 BC

Tiberius Gracchus is elected in 133 BC

Sulla becomes dictator in 82 BC

Sulla resigns as dictator in 80 BC and dies in 78 BC

WEEK 1 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 2

The Beginning of the Story

Materials: Sacajawea

→ INTRO

By the age of 16, Sacajawea had been kidnapped from her tribe, gambled away to be a man's second wife, and was pregnant with that man's baby. That's when she would join the journey of Meriwether Lewis and William Clark down the Mississippi River and to the Pacific Ocean. But, where did her story begin?

Joseph Bruchac will explore the early life of Sacajawea as well as recount her journey with Lewis and Clark, which became one of the most famous expeditions to take place in American History. While it is well researched and Joseph Bruchac uses primary sources like the journals of Lewis and Clark as support for the story, it remains a work of fiction. There is much that we don't know about Sacajawea's story.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Begin with the "Author's Note" p.195-199.

Read the Prologue and Ch.1.

- How different would Sacajawea's life have been if she had stayed amongst her people?

• IMPORTANT DATES

Thomas Jefferson is voted in as the 3rd president of the United States in 1800

• TERMINOLOGY

The Minnatree tribe was also known as the Hidatsa tribe. Hidatsa is the more common name.

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 2 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 2

A Terrible Mistake, Following the Eagle

Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→ RECAP

What is happening so far in the book?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.14-28 "We did not" - "Something peaceful."

- What do you think about the idea of allowing a man's family to travel with him in war?
- How would you prove your age? Why was it hard for Lorenzo to prove he was only fifteen?

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Picture of General Antonio López de Santa Anna

WEEK 2 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 3

Antebellum, The Long Way West

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ INTRO

Where can we find the words "We hold these truths to be self-evident, that all men are created equal, that they are endowed by their Creator with certain unalienable Rights, that among these are Life, Liberty and the pursuit of Happiness"? (Declaration of Independence) What would you say is happiness? What did people in the 1800's think it was? For many people, it meant owning land. This year, you will read extensively about people exploring new lands, migrating to new places, and the formation of new states.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Poem on p.5
2. Preface & Ch.1 p.9-15 (Read the narrative and then go back and read captions and sidebars.)

- How did Long describe his findings from the edge of the plains of the Mississippi woodlands to the Rocky Mountains?

• DEFINITIONS

yeoman farmer (p.10): a person who owns and cultivates a small farm

cash crop (p.10): a readily salable crop (such as cotton or tobacco) produced or gathered primarily for market

WEEK 2 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 2

Meeting Sulla Continued...

Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ RECAP

Review the timeline at the beginning of the chapter and think back to last week's readings. What do you remember about Sulla?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.6 p.99-107 - start at "the Coming Men"

- What in the chapter was surprising to you?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.14-15.
Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 2 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 4

The Corps of Discovery, Among the Minnetarees

Materials: Sacajawea

→ INTRO

In the election of 1800, Thomas Jefferson was announced as the third president of the United States. Arguably, one of his greatest actions as president came to be known as the Louisiana Purchase. Around the summer of 1803, after the Louisiana Purchase, Thomas Jefferson would choose a group of people, including William Clark and Meriwether Lewis, to explore the newly acquired land. They would be called the Corps of Discovery.

→ VIEW

∞ Link: Louisiana Purchase, 1803

Read through the page and view the map for more information about the Louisiana Purchase.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.2-3 p.8-23 "Where was I" - "up the river."

- How did Sacajawea describe her time with the Minnetaree people?

• IMPORTANT DATES

Thomas Jefferson completes the Louisiana Purchase in 1803
Thomas Jefferson sends Lewis and Clark on the expedition in 1804

• DEFINITIONS

ensign (p.9): a junior officer in the military

WEEK 3 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 3

Following the Eagle, The Deserters

Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→ RECAP

Tell briefly what you read.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.28-42 "I have played" - "happen, again, sir."

- What were some reasons men would desert the army?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview the crude comment on p.34 made by Bernardo.

WEEK 3 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 5

Mountain Men, Riding the Trail to Santa Fe

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.2-3 p.16-25

- Why was the discovery of the South Pass so important?

WEEK 3 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 3

Spartacus and a Revolt

Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ INTRO

Rome was built on slavery. In 73 BC, there were more than a million people enslaved in Rome's Italian lands. As Pascal Hughes says, "Some have been bought from foreign merchants, others taken by military conquest, or enslaved as a punishment for criminality. Then there are the unfortunates who were born into bondage, or who are the victims of

• IMPORTANT DATES

Spartacus leads his revolt in 73

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

kidnap by slavers, or who could see no other option in life than to sell themselves into servitude."
However, revolution came to Rome, and it was led by a slave named Spartacus. There are modern-day movies that praise the bravery of this man and those who rose up with him against the powers that shackled them. Spartacus' story is fraught with bravery and peril, yet it left him a legend in the history books.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.7 p.110-118 - stop at "Third Servile War"

- How did Spartacus' actions influence the Roman Empire?

→ LOCATE

📄 Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.14-15.
Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

WEEK 3 📅 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 6

York, Stories up the River, and Looking for Indians

📄 Materials: Sacajawea

→ INTRO

One of the men who aided in the expedition was a man named York, who had grown up enslaved by the Clark family. He would be helpful on the expedition, but Lewis and Clark also knew that they needed someone who knew the lands they were sent to explore. These lands had been places no white man had ever entered before.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.23-33 "Bad as the" - "a Supr. quallity."

- What were some struggles that the expedition encountered early on?

★ STUDENT/TEACHER NOTE

Quallity is intentionally misspelled as this is how it's written in the journal.

★ TEACHER NOTE

Due to some of the content, skip p.20-22.

WEEK 4 📅 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 4

The Deserters, A Thing of the Past

📄 Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.42-59 "Lieutenant Ochoa shouted" - "that haughty Esteban?"

- Why do you think the punishments were so severe for deserters?

WEEK 4 📅 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 7

Trail of Tears

📄 Materials: PDF link

→ INTRO

The settlers wanted more land. The Native American Tribes inhabited this land. So between 1816 and 1840, Tribes, including Cherokees, Chickasaws, Creeks, Seminoles, and Choctaws, signed treaties that gave up their land to the US. Around 1829, Andrew Jackson and Congress passed an act called the Indian Removal Act that forced remaining tribes to move west. There were over 100,000 Native Americans who were forced from their homes to make a journey that many of them would not survive.

• IMPORTANT DATES

James Madison elected as president and serves from 1809-1817

• EXTRA HELPING

This video takes you through a part of the Trail of Tears as it looks now.

∞ **Video Link:** Trail of Tears video

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

PDF Link: Trail of Tears (from Hakim's History of US Vol. 4)

WEEK 4 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 4

The Beginning of a Legend

Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ RECAP

Review the timeline at the beginning of the chapter and think back to last week's readings. What do you remember about Spartacus?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.7 p.118-126 - start at "To Vesuvius"

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

∞ Video Link: From Enslavement to Rebel Gladiator: The Life of Spartacus
Watch the 5-minute video that summarizes Spartacus' revolt and then discuss the similarities and differences between the video and the chapter you've completed.

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.14-15.
Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

WEEK 4 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 8

Looking for Indians, Little Mice

Materials: Sacajawea

→ INTRO

The news about the expedition had spread, and tribes awaited the vessel that was rumored to be "a boat with many guns." Lewis and Clark's expedition also served another purpose. They were to act as messengers to the tribes that they had a new leader: the President of the United States.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.33-44 "those plains were" - "we will follow."

- How are Lewis and Clark greeted by the various tribes they encounter?
- How does Sacajawea remember the arrival of the Clark expedition?

WEEK 5 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 5

El Presidio

Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ LOCATE

∞ Map Link: Map of Mexico
Find San Luis Potosí. How would you describe the terrain of this area?
Lorenzo visits this village with his fellow conscripts.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.60-75 "On the fourth" - "soldiers shut up."

• DEFINITIONS

peons: (p.60) person of low social status or a laborer with no skills

★ TEACHER NOTE

There is a description of a woman's body on p.62 that you might want to preview.

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

- How did Lorenzo feel at the idea of visiting another village outside of his own?

WEEK 5 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 9

Susan Magoffin's Diary, Pioneers: Taking the Trail West

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.4-5 p.26-37

• IMPORTANT DATES

James Monroe elected as president and serves from 1817-1825

Missouri Compromise 1820

WEEK 5 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 5

Introducing Caesar

Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ INTRO

Around the end of the 15th century, William Shakespeare wrote a tragedy titled Julius Caesar. The story of Julius Caesar captured audiences' attention then, and it remains prominent in our modern-day culture. The blood, betrayal, and scandal of the story is what has led to this story's permanence. But as you will read, there is more to this story. Julius Caesar becomes a famous leader for a number of reasons. As you read through the story retold by Pascal Hughes, consider the many reasons Julius Caesar's story might attract so much attention.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.8 p.128-137- stop at "even bigger one"

- Why is Julius Caesar's story so infamous?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.14-15.

Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

WEEK 5 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 10

Making Peace, the White Men's Fort

Materials: Sacajawea

→ INTRO

One of the biggest dangers when encountering explorers was what they brought with them. Smallpox was one such danger and Native Americans and their remedies were no match for the virus. For those who survived the virus, it left them scarred. Though there had been some remedies that showed improvement, the reality was that Native American tribes were ill-prepared to face such a virus.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.8-9 p.45-59

- How does Sacajawea describe the fort?

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 6 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 6

El Presidio, El Presidente

Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.75-90 "Return to your" - "to be there."

- How does Lorenzo view education? How does El Presidente view music? What do their views tell you about what's important to Lorenzo and El Presidente?

★ TEACHER NOTE

There is an implication on p.89 that you might want to preview.

WEEK 6 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 11

Getting There, Latter-Day Saints

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.6-7 p.38-47

- What would it have been like to travel in a wagon train?

● STUDENT TIP

Be sure to add some people, events, and drawings of artifacts to your book of centuries.

● IMPORTANT DATES

John Quincy Adams elected as president and serves from 1825-1829

Indian Removal Act of 1830

Martin Van Buren elected as president and serves from 1837-1841

WEEK 6 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 6

Caesar's Antics

Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ RECAP

Review the timeline at the beginning of the chapter and think back to last week's readings. What did you learn about Caesar?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.8 p.137-152 - start at "Triumvirate"

- What was the most interesting thing in this week's reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.14-15.

Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

● IMPORTANT DATES

Julius Caesar is assassinated in 44 BC

WEEK 6 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 12

Charbonneau's Demands, Departures

Materials: Sacajawea

→ NOTE

We are skipping Ch.10 for the sake of time.

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.11-12 p.63-73

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

- What benefits did one receive for being on the expedition with Lewis and Clark?

WEEK 7 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 7

El Presidente, The Importance of Goats

Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→ INTRO

Lorenzo and Estaban find themselves in a tricky situation. As you read through this section, think about how many people went through similar situations to Lorenzo. What would you do if you were accused of something and no one was listening to you?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.90-103 "Esteban and I" - "wanted to hear."

WEEK 7 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 13

Coast-to-Coast Destiny, Texas: Tempting and Beautiful

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ NOTE

We are skipping Ch.9 since we are reading about Frémont in geography.

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.8 & 10 p.48-53, 58-63

• IMPORTANT DATES

James K. Polk elected as president and serves from 1845-1849

Gold Rush of 1849 in California
Compromise of 1850

WEEK 7 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 7

Introducing Octavian

Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ INTRO

With Julius Caesar's death came the question of who would succeed him. That position would fall upon Octavian. But it would not be easy to assume the position, as others would be looking to take his place. Make sure to note any questions that come up from the reading. You can either discuss these questions with someone or write them down.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.9 p.154-164 - end at "of the Roman World"

- What was the most interesting thing in this week's reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.14-15.
Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

• IMPORTANT DATES

The second Triumvirate is formed in 43 BC

WEEK 7 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 14

The Great Falls, Flash Flood, The Three Forks

Materials: Sacajawea

→ NOTE

We are skipping Ch.13-15 for the sake of time.

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

→ INTRO

Sacajawea found herself able to help the expedition in more ways than just translating for her people. Growing up in the village, she knew that there would come a time when it would be impossible to hunt and that the survival of people depended on finding food in other ways. Mainly, she taught them how to forage for edible roots.

There would be more difficulties than just running low on food. One of the largest would be grizzly bears. Even though Lewis and Clark were outfitted with guns and bullets, they had a hard time taking down the grizzlies, which caused Captain Lewis to say, "these bears being so hard to die rather intimidates me." A canoe nearly sank, animals charged their tents, and Sacajawea came down with an illness.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.16-18 p.90-104

- How does Sacajawea help guide Lewis and Clark? What does she contribute to the company of explorers?

WEEK 8 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 8

A Rumor of War, Feliz Navidad

Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→ RECAP

Tell briefly what you read.

→ LOCATE

∞ Map Link: Mexico

Find Saltillo and Coahuila on the map.

Lorenzo and the rest of the army pack up to head to these towns.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.104-120 "I was an" - "this pace last?"

★ TEACHER NOTE

There is a situation that you might want to preview on p.109.

WEEK 8 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 15

Fighting Over a Border, There's Gold In Them Hills

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.11-12 p.64-77

- What is something that shocked you in this reading?

WEEK 8 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 8

Antony and Cleopatra

Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ RECAP

Review the timeline at the beginning of the chapter and think back to last week's readings. What did you learn about Octavian?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.9 p.164-172 - start at "Antony and Cleopatra"

- There is much debate in the historical community as to the reasons the

• STUDENT TIP

Be sure to add some people, events, and drawings of artifacts to your book of centuries. Mark potential items with a Post-it note as you read so you remember to find something when you sit down to work in your book.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Mark Antony and Cleopatra are defeated and both die in 30 BC
History of Rome is written by Livy between 27 BC and 9 BC

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

Roman Republic fell. What do you think contributed to the fall of the Roman Empire?

→ LOCATE

📄 Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.14-15.
Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

Jesus is crucified around 33 AD
Jesus resurpects around 33 AD

WEEK 8 📅 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 16

What do you Call Us, Finding the Shoshones, Reunion

📄 Materials: Sacajawea

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.19-21 p.105-124

- Why were the Shoshones hesitant to follow Captain Lewis?

WEEK 9 📅 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 9

Feliz Navidad, The General's Orders, La Llorona

📄 Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→ INTRO

Three Kings Day, or Epiphany, as it is called, celebrates the day the three wise men encountered the Baby Jesus and brought him gifts. It's also the day that many kids get their presents. Epiphany, or Three Kings Day, is celebrated all over the world, and its traditions differ from people group to people group.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.120-135 "On Christmas Eve" - "in their hands."

- How do Lorenzo's Christmas traditions differ from your own? Are you familiar with any of his traditions?

WEEK 9 📅 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 17

Clipper Ships and Pony Express, Flying By Stagecoach

📄 Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.13-14 p.78-89

- How did Clipper Ships and the Pony Express impact the United States?

• IMPORTANT DATES

William Henry Harrison elected as president and serves in 1841
William Henry Harrison gets sick and dies after only just 31 days in office

WEEK 9 📅 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 9

Nero

📄 Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ INTRO

Emperor Nero is another famous ruler, but his notoriety comes from the evil that he did as Emperor of Rome. Nero was most known for his murder of anyone who opposed or threatened him. And as Jesus' popularity had increased and his teachings had spread, Nero picked out a new target for

★ TEACHER TIP

This chapter may have sensitive content. Depictions of martyrdom are essential to understanding the early church's plight, but Nero is known for his horrific treatment of people whom he saw as enemies.

• IMPORTANT DATES

The Great Fire of Rome in 64 AD

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

his ire: the Christians. Martyrdom under Nero would become infamously horrendous. It is from Nero's time that we have many stories of men and women who died for Christ.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.10 p.174-184 - stop at "this bore Nero."

→ LOCATE

📍 Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.14-15.

Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

WEEK 9 📅 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 18

The Welcome, New Names, The Terrible Trail, Quamash

📍 Materials: Sacajawea

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.22-25 p.125-141

- How does Sacajawea react to finding her tribe? Her family?

WEEK 10 📅 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 10

La Llorona, White Death

📍 Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→ RECAP

Tell briefly what you read.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.135-150 "For over a" - "step for step."

- La Llorona is an urban legend in Lorenzo's culture. What are some urban legends you are familiar with?

WEEK 10 📅 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 19

Arithmetic at Sea, Thar She Blows

📍 Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ INTRO

Whaling is just one of the many industries that became more and more popular in the 1800s.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.15-16 p.90-101

- Does anything surprise you in this week's reading?

• IMPORTANT DATES

John Tyler becomes president and serves from 1841-1845

WEEK 10 📅 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 10

Nero Continued...

📍 Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ RECAP

Review the timeline at the beginning of the chapter and think back to last week's readings. What did you learn about Nero?

★ TEACHER TIP

This chapter may have sensitive content. Depictions of martyrdom are essential to understanding the early church's plight, but Nero is known for his horrific treatment of people whom he saw as enemies.

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.10 p.184-191 - start at "The despot"

→ LOCATE

📄 Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.14-15.
Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

WEEK 10 📅 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 20

Many Rapids, Many Nations, The Great Hungry Water, At Fort Clatsop, Thieves, Doctoring the Nez Percé

📄 Materials: Sacajawea

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.26-30 p.142-167

- Why was writing so important to Lewis and Clark?

WEEK 11 📅 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 11

White Death, Tejas

📄 Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→ RECAP

Tell briefly what you read.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.150-166 "By February 13" - "sage-covered plain."

- How does Lorenzo deal with the loss of his family members?

★ TEACHER NOTE

There is a situation that you might want to preview on p.160.

WEEK 11 📅 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 21

A Japanese Boy in America, Cities and Progress

📄 Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.17-18 p.102-111

WEEK 11 📅 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 11

Catch-Up Day

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.
Work on your Book of Centuries

WEEK 11 📅 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 22

Deep Snow, Five Fingers Parted, The Journey's End, Old Friends No Longer with Us, The Final Word

📄 Materials: Sacajawea

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1	
→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.31-35 p.167-194	
WEEK 12 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 12 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: In the Shadow of the Alamo	
WEEK 12 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 23 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Sacajawea	
WEEK 12 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 12 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: A Short History of Ancient Rome	
WEEK 12 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 24 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860	

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 1 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 13

Tejas, San Antonio de Bèxar

Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→ RECAP

Tell briefly what you read.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.166-180 "We marched along" - "help us all."

- What is surprising about this part of Lorenzo's journey?

WEEK 1 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 25

A Land of Movers, Workin' on the Railroad

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.19-20 p.112-119

- How would the railroad affect people differently?

• STUDENT TIP

Be sure to add some people, events, and drawings of artifacts to your book of centuries.

WEEK 1 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 13

Boudica

Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ INTRO

Transitions of power did not have a large effect on the growth of the empire. Rome kept invading territories, but these people groups resisted. One such group was led by Boudica, who would become famous for her story of rebellion and revenge. Make sure to note any questions that come up from the reading. You can either discuss these questions with someone or write them down.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.11 p.194-200 - end at "list of concerns"

- What was the most interesting thing in this week's reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.14-15.
Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

★ TEACHER TIP

This chapter may have sensitive content. Boudica's story is full of peril and contains violence towards women.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Boudica is killed after her uprising in 61 AD

WEEK 1 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 26

Waiting for Mr. Lincoln, Born into Slavery

Materials: Abraham Lincoln and Frederick Douglass: The Story Behind an American Friendship

→ INTRO

This book begins in 1863, two years after the Civil War started. Abraham Lincoln was the President and never thought the war would last this long. He was trying to hold the country together as best he could. Frederick Douglass, who was a formerly enslaved man, became one of the strongest voices against slavery. Although Lincoln and Douglass initially disagreed about various matters, their discussions were profitable and instrumental

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview the sentence on p.12 where Frederick talks about taking his life.

• DEFINITIONS

calling card: also known as a visiting card, a small, decorative card that was carried by individuals to present themselves to others (p.2)

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

to the cause of freedom.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.1-2 p.1-17

- What does the rule against teaching a slave to read tell you about the importance of books?
- How did learning to read influence the decisions of Frederick?

WEEK 2 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 14

Dawn at the Alamo

Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→ NOTE

Due to the graphic description of the aftermath of the war, we are skipping several sections. Please note the page numbers that are listed.

→ RECAP

Tell briefly what you read.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Ch.16 p.181-190
2. selection of Ch.17 p.197-200 "In what seemed" - "this behind you."
3. selection of Ch.17 p.203-207 "I began searching" - end.

- What surprised you in the reading?

WEEK 2 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 27

She Wishes to Ornament Their Minds, Do Girls Have Brains

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.21-22 p.120-129

- How did people view women in the 1800s? How did that change through the years?

WEEK 2 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 14

Boudica Continued...

Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ RECAP

Review the timeline at the beginning of the chapter and think back to last week's readings. What did you learn about Boudica?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.11 p.201-211 - start at "Trouble Brewing"

- Discuss Boudica's lasting impact on the Roman Empire.

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.14-15.
Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

★ TEACHER TIP

This chapter may have sensitive content. Boudica's story is full of peril and contains violence towards women.

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 2 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 28

Soul on Fire, Nothing but Plenty of Friends

Materials: Abraham Lincoln and Frederick Douglass: The Story Behind an American Friendship

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.3-4 p.19-41

- What do you find interesting about Douglass' journey from a slave to a famous writer and lecturer?
- How did Lincoln become a self-made man?

WEEK 3 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 15

A Small Affair, A Quiet Death

Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→RECAP

Tell briefly what you read.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Skip the beginning of Ch.18 and begin at p.214-229 "Suddenly I saw" - end

- What could have been different if General Santa Anna had waited for reinforcements?

WEEK 3 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 29

Seneca Falls and the Rights of Women, A Woman Named Truth, Life in the Mills

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.23-25 p.130-141

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Why Sojourner Truth Changed Her Name
Watch the video to learn more about Sojourner Truth.

- What did you learn about Sojourner in the reading or the video?

WEEK 3 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 15

Julia Felix

Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ INTRO

One of the most infamous events in history is the eruption of Mount Vesuvius. There are many scholars and archeologists dedicated to understanding and unearthing the many cities impacted by this eruption. Pompeii is the city most people are familiar with, as it was completely buried. Pompeii was located in the Bay of Naples and had around 10,000 - 20,000 inhabitants. Make sure to note any questions that come up from the reading. You can either discuss these questions with someone or write

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

them down.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.12 p.214-227

- What impact did Mount Vesuvius' eruption have on the empire?

→ LOCATE

📍 Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.14-15.

Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

WEEK 3 📅 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 30

A House Divided, Debating the Future of Slavery in America

📖 Materials: Abraham Lincoln and Frederick Douglass: The Story Behind an American Friendship

→ RECAP

Briefly summarize what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.5-6 p.43-63

- What do you think about Lincoln's view of slavery at this point? Do you disagree with any aspects of it?

WEEK 4 📅 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 16

The Advance

📖 Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→ RECAP

Tell briefly what you read.

→ LOCATE

∞ Map Link: Mexico

Find San Antonio.

Lorenzo says, "As we marched past the ruins of the Alamo, my heart ached. Here we had fought a vain and pointless battle and lost the flower of our army for no cause other than the egotism of His Excellency."

Lorenzo and the rest of his unit would have fought in what is now San Antonio, Texas.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.20 p.230-242 "Our division pulled" - "on its prow."

Ch.21 p.252-262 "As we plodded" - "men were doomed."

★ TEACHER NOTE

Due to sensitive content, students will skip from p.242-252.

WEEK 4 📅 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 31

Working Women and Children, American Writers

📖 Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.26-27 p.142-149

- How familiar are you with the writers of the 1800s? Have you read or interacted with any of the books mentioned in this section?

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 4 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 16

Trajan

Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ INTRO

Who is going to be the most successful emperor of Rome? Pascal Hughes writes, "Ruling from AD 98 to 117, Trajan will become one of the most beloved of all the Roman emperors. A man who conquered new territories, grew the empire as far as anyone would and enriched Rome with awe-inspiring building projects. Indeed, the Senate will welcome future emperors with the wish that they be melior Traiano ('better than Trajan') - evidence that he is to be the benchmark for all who follow." Make sure to note any questions that come up from the reading. You can either discuss these questions with someone or write them down.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.13 p.229-239 - end at "words, best emperor"

- What was the most interesting thing in this week's reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.14-15.
Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Trajan grows the empire to its biggest size in 117 AD
Hadrian's Wall is built in 122 AD

WEEK 4 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 32

Emancipation, Mr. Douglass

Materials: Abraham Lincoln and Frederick Douglass: The Story Behind an American Friendship

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.7-8 p.65-85

- Why didn't Lincoln initially think he had the authority to free the slaves?
- What does it say about President Lincoln that even though Frederick couldn't agree with him, he could "respect his humane spirit"?

WEEK 5 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 17

Toward Destiny, San Jacinto

Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→ RECAP

Tell briefly what you read.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.262-280 "That night the" - end of book

- Why did Lorenzo make the choice he made at the beginning of the chapter?

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 5 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 33

Mr. Thoreau, Melville and Company

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.28-29 p.150-155

- Thoreau wrote, "In Wildness is the preservation of the World." Do you agree?

WEEK 5 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 17

Trajan Continued...

Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ RECAP

Review the timeline at the beginning of the chapter and think back to last week's readings. What did you learn about Trajan?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.13 p.239-246 - start at "The Peerless Roman Military"

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.4-15.

Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

WEEK 5 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 34

Lincoln's Secret Plan, My Friend Douglass

Materials: Abraham Lincoln and Frederick Douglass: The Story Behind an American Friendship

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.9-10 p.87-103

- How would you describe the friendship of Lincoln and Douglass?

WEEK 6 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 18

Showdown in Paris

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People, notebook

→ INTRO

When you think of Paris, France, what image comes to mind? For most people, it is the Eiffel Tower. But did you know that many people were against the building of the Eiffel Tower, and many obstacles almost prevented the Eiffel Tower from being built? This book will tell that story. It also tells the story about what life was like at the end of the 19th century and introduces us to people from around the world.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Ch.1 p.1-12 (Read the narrative and skip blue pages.) Beginning - "too-tight corset."
2. Blue pages p.14-16 (Optional p.4-5)

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview the incident mentioned at the top of p.11 that talks about James Bennett's drunken behavior.

• DEFINITIONS

uncouth: behaving in a rude way
: not polite or socially acceptable

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

- Why do you think it was important for the French to build something taller than the Americans?

→ VIEW

This 555-foot stone pillar was the tallest human-made structure at the time.

∞ Image Link: Washington Monument

→ NOTEBOOK

Each chapter features recurring characters who were connected in some way to the 1889 World's Fair. Create a graphic organizer or a list that will help you keep track of the individuals that you will encounter in this text. You may want to put only one or two people on a page so you have room to add details. You will add to these pages when you encounter the character again in a subsequent chapter. A list of the people mentioned in this book is listed on p. ix-xi. It might be helpful to look back at it as you read. Begin your list of characters: Gustave Eiffel, Annie Oakley, William F. Cody (Buffalo Bill), Thomas Edison.

This is an example of a graphic organizer that creates a timeline for the character. You can also just list descriptions about them in a column.

∞ Image Link: Example of graphic organizer

WEEK 6 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 35

If a Poet Writes You a Letter, Pay Attention, Amistad means Friendship

📖 Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ NOTE

We are skipping Ch.31 because we are reading about John James Audubon in geography.

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.30 & 32 p.156-161, 171-176

WEEK 6 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 18

Colosseum

📖 Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ INTRO

As you read about the Colosseum in this chapter, think about your familiarity with the Colosseum.

→ READ & NARRATE

Ch.14 p.247-259

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

∞ Link: Virtual Tour of the Colosseum

Explore the Colosseum virtually.

- Discuss the modern-day Colosseum and the things you learned about it from the virtual tour.

→ LOCATE

📖 Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.14-15.

Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

• IMPORTANT DATES

The Pantheon is constructed in 126 AD



Term 2

WEEK 6 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 36

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ INTRO

This historical novel is based on the building of the transcontinental railroad, which took place from 1863-1869. It was an arduous, dangerous job for the men who signed up to do it. Historians estimate that at any one time as many as 10,000 to 15,000 Chinese were working on constructing the railroad. It took more than four years to complete the western section of the railroad and connect the coasts. This story will bring this time period to life and give you a glimpse of what those workers endured so they could send money back to their families in China. Upon completion of the railroad, some workers went back to China; others stayed in America to work in agriculture, mining, logging, or domestic service or work in manufacturing to produce cigars and other items.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Read author's note p.274-276
2. p.1-12 beginning - "to say or do."

- What customs or traditions in Chinese culture have you noticed so far?"

→ BACKGROUND

1. Foot binding — the practice of applying tight binding to the feet of young girls to prevent further growth — was a Chinese custom historically associated with the wealthy. Small feet were considered more attractive and, therefore, necessary to find a more suitable partner. It was banned in 1911, but the practice continued in rural areas until circa 1949, when women were forced to remove the bindings on their "lotus feet" by governmental decree.
 2. Read the top sections of this article to learn about the Taiping Rebellion, which Ling Fan's dad was accused of being a part of.
- ∞ Article Link: Taiping Rebellion

WEEK 7 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 19

Showdown in Paris, Eiffel Under Attack

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People, notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. p.13-29 "Many Americans were" - "French Catholic parents."
2. (Optional) Blue pages on p.30-32

- Why do you think world fairs were such an important event, especially in that time period?
- Why do you think America and France seemed to be in competition with each other?

→ VIEW

You can view a few of the paintings of James McNeill Whistler, the American painter based in England, known for post-impressionism.

∞ Link: Paintings of James McNeill Whistler

→ NOTEBOOK

Add more names to your character list: James McNeill Whistler, Van Gogh Brothers, Paul Gauguin.

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 7 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 37

Webster Defends the Union, Fleeing to Freedom

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ NOTE

We are skipping Ch.34-35 because those topics are covered in the Lincoln & Douglass book.

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ IN THE NOVEL MASTER SLAVE HUSBAND WIFE, ILYON WOO WROTE THE STORY OF WILLIAM AND ELLEN CRAFT. SHE WROTE, "IN 1848 WILLIAM AND ELLEN CRAFT, AN ENSLAVED COUPLE IN GEORGIA, EMBARKED UPON A FIVE-THOUSAND-MILE JOURNEY OF MUTUAL SELF-EMANCIPATION ACROSS THE WORLD. THEIRS IS A LOVE STORY THAT BEGINS IN A TIME OF REVOLUTION—A REVOLUTION UNFINISHED IN THE AMERICAN WAR FOR INDEPENDENCE, A REVOLUTION THAT ENDURES." AS YOU READ THROUGH THEIR STORY (CH.36), TAKE NOTE OF ALL THE DIFFERENT THINGS THAT THEY NEEDED TO DO IN ORDER TO ESCAPE INTO FREEDOM.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.33 & 36 p.177-179, 188-190

WEEK 7 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 19

Severus

Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ INTRO

Pascal Hughes writes, "Almost fifty years earlier, in the African port city of Leptis Magna (in modern day Libya), a high-ranking family welcomes a new baby in 145. The child, Lucius Septimius Severus, reflects Rome's multicultural identity, his mother from an Italian background and his father with Punic, or Carthaginian, heritage. Severus can count consuls among his cousins, while his mother's line are the Fulvia, one of Rome's grand patrician families."

Lucius Septimius Severus would become an emperor of Rome and would be known for creating a military monarchy. As you read more about this emperor, make sure to note any questions that come up from the reading. You can either discuss these questions with someone or write them down.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.15 p.261-270 - stop at "what comes next?"

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.14-15.
Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Emperor Severus creates a military monarchy 193 AD

WEEK 7 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 38

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ RECAP

What is going on so far in the story?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

★ TEACHER NOTE

There is a reference to a woman's cycle on p.25.



Term 2

p.13-26 "Ling Fan shook" - "hot as a cinder."

- What do you notice about the way marriage is approached in that culture?

→ BACKGROUND

Qingming is a festival for honoring ancestors that is celebrated on the 15th day after the spring equinox, generally falling in early April. The main activity is the cleaning or sweeping of ancestral tombs, and thus it is sometimes referred to as "Tomb Sweeping Day." The festival is an ancient one, dating back at least 2,500 years in Chinese history. (mentioned on p.23 of book)

WEEK 8 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 20

Eiffel Under Attack

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People, notebook

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. p.33-49 "On June 12" - "to complete it."
2. (Optional) Blue pages p.50-51

- Why do you think Gustave Eiffel was so determined to build the tower, even if he had to use his own money?
- Why do you think so many people were against the building of the tower?

→ NOTEBOOK

Add information to your character list for Gustave Eiffel.

WEEK 8 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 39

Over the River and Underground, Seven Decades

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.37-38 p.191-198

- What was most shocking in these chapters?

• IMPORTANT DATES

Zachery Taylor elected as president and serves from 1849-1850

Millard Fillmore elected as president and serves from 1850-1853

Franklin Pierce elected as president and serves from 1853-1857

James Buchanan elected as president and serves from 1857-1861

WEEK 8 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 20

Severus Continued...

Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ RECAP

Review the timeline at the beginning of the chapter and think back to last week's readings. What did you learn about Severus?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.15 p.270-278 - start at "The Year of the Five Emperors"

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

→ LOCATE

📄 Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.14-15.
Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

WEEK 8 📅 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 40

📄 Materials: Gold Mountain

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ LOCATE

∞ Map Link: Map of China

1. Locate the Pearl River. The ship went down this river to the village where Ling Fan lived.
2. Find Guangzhou. This is the busy seaport where men board a bigger ship bound for America.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.26-40 "That night" - "she stepped forward."

→ BACKGROUND

Why did the Chinese call America "Gold Mountain"?

In the 1840s, the news circled the globe: There was gold in California, and fortunes could be made by anyone who seized the opportunity. Within weeks, dreamers from far and wide came streaming into America's port cities, hoping to stake a claim and strike it rich. China was not immune to this new gold fever. Word of a mountain of gold across the ocean arrived in Hong Kong in 1849, and quickly spread throughout the Chinese provinces. By 1851, 25,000 Chinese immigrants had left their homes and moved to California, a land some came to call gam saan, or "gold mountain." (from History of Congress website)

WEEK 9 📅 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 21

Troubles on the Tower

📄 Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People, notebook

→ RECAP

Where are we in the story?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. p.55-73
2. (Optional) Blue pages p.62-63

→ VIEW

∞ Link: Gauguin painting

Look at this painting from when Gauguin was in Arles and read the paragraph explaining it.

→ NOTEBOOK

Add information to your character list: Gustave Eiffel, James McNeill Whistler, Van Gogh brothers, Paul Gauguin, Buffalo Bill, Annie Oakley.

WEEK 9 📅 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 41

📄 Materials: Book of Centuries, Story of US (Optional)

→ NOTEBOOK

Take this time to work on your Book of Centuries. Include dates for U.S., World, Ancient, and Church history. Dates are in the various lessons under

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

"Important Dates" or on p.199 of The Story of US. Don't forget to draw items as well that represent the 19th century. There are examples in the back of the Our Work books.

WEEK 9 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 21

Zenobia and Decline

Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ INTRO

Pascal Hughes writes, "A crowd has gathered in Alexandria, Egypt, one day around AD 271. Standing on a ceremonial platform beneath a radiant sun is a woman of about thirty, gazing out across the throng assembled in her honor. Her name is Zenobia, and she is building a reputation for herself as a force to be reckoned with." Make sure to note any questions that come up from the reading. You can either discuss these questions with someone or write them down.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.16 p.279-291 - stop at "in the east"

- Discuss the impact of Zenobia on the Roman Empire.

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.14-15.
Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Constantine becomes the first Christian emperor of Rome in 306 AD
Rome divides into two empires in 395 AD

WEEK 9 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 42

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Skip the beginning of the chapter (p.41-47) for the sake of time and some crass descriptions.
2. p.47-61 "Sometime in the middle"- "the new country."

- Do you think Ling Fan's plan will work, or will she be found out?

→ VIEW

Throughout the lessons, you will be watching segments from a webinar that was hosted by the Chinese Railroad Workers in North America Project at Stanford University. Some people might think that history is about dates and events and that there is nothing new to find out about the past. But when we look at primary sources, there might be "new stories" to uncover that are not part of the usual narrative. That is what historians do. They study primary sources to answer questions about the past. Primary sources are forms of evidence that come directly from the period or persons or events we are seeking to understand. These can be journals, letters, photos, newspapers, and other writings. That is what this project is about. We don't know a lot about the Chinese railroad workers who came to America in the late 1800s to find jobs and build America. These historians are trying to bring these stories to us.

This segment talks about the project and the kinds of primary sources they studied.

∞ Video Link: Stanford University Research (7:30-11:30)

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 10 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 22

Going Up!

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People, notebook

→ RECAP

Briefly summarize the previous reading.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.75-89 "February 4, 1899" - "the cars themselves."

→ NOTEBOOK

Make a sketch of the Eiffel Tower. You can use pictures in the book or the link given.

∞ Image Link: Eiffel Tower

WEEK 10 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 43

Architecture

Materials: Notebook

→ NOTE

For the next two weeks, you will be learning about different styles of homes that were common in America in the 1800s.

→ INTRO

Do you see any buildings or homes in your area that have columns? Around 1820, a movement of Old World architectural styles gained popularity in the U.S. The first of these movements was inspired by the temples of ancient Greece.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Read the first paragraph and the section called "All Roads Lead to...Greece."

∞ Article Link: The Old is New Again

2. Read about Farmer's Greek Revival homes (from To Grandfather's House We Go).

∞ PDF Link: Architecture in the 1800s

→ SKETCH

Look at the Greek Revival house and sketch any details you would like into your notebook.

∞ Image Link: Greek Revival House

WEEK 10 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 22

Zenobia and Decline Continued...

Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ RECAP

Review the timeline at the beginning of the chapter and think back to last week's readings. What did you learn about Zenobia and Rome's decline?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.16 p.291-296 - start at "Out of the Shadows"

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.14-15.

Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 10 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 44

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.62-74 "Perhaps the imminent" - "San Francisco sunshine."

→ VIEW

This part of the webinar talks about the kinds of ships the Chinese sailed on.

∞ Video Link: Stanford University Research (11:40-14:48)

★ TEACHER NOTE

Note the use of curse words on p.74. One in today's reading, and one in the next reading.

WEEK 11 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 23

Going Up! (cont.)

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People, notebook

→ RECAP

What was the last reading about?

→ INTRO

Do you have anything in your home that has an Eiffel Tower on it or a small model of one? Eiffel Tower mania became a thing back in 1889!

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. p.89-108 "As the months" - "of American tourists."
2. (Optional) Blue pages on p.90-91, 100-101

- Why do you think the people who criticized the tower came to appreciate it?
- What do you think was the most challenging part about building the tower?

→ NOTEBOOK

Add information to your character list for Gustave Eiffel and Annie Oakley.

WEEK 11 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 45

Architecture

Materials: Notebook

→ INTRO

Today, we will look at another architectural style influenced by the Old World—Gothic Revival. These homes in the 1800s were romantic adaptations of medieval architecture. Delicate wooden ornaments and other decorative details suggested the architecture of medieval England. These homes did not try to replicate authentic Gothic styles—no flying buttresses were needed to hold up the Gothic Revival homes found throughout America. Instead, they became the elegant farm homes of a growing America. Here are some of the characteristics:

- Pointed windows with decorative tracery
- Grouped chimneys
- Pinnacles (spires or peaks)
- Leaded glass
- Quatrefoil and clover-shaped windows
- Oriel windows- bay window that projects from an upper floor and is supported by a bracket
- Asymmetrical floor plan
- Steeply pitched roofs

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read Gothic Revival Rectory House on the second page of the PDF. (from To Grandfather's House We Go)

∞ PDF Link: Architecture in the 1800s

→ VIEW

Look at these examples of Gothic Revival found in the US.

1. ∞ Image Link: St. Francisville Inn (Baton Rouge, LA)
2. ∞ Image Link: The Lake-Peterson House (Rockford, IL)
3. ∞ Image Link: Gothic Revival Rectory (Old Saybrook, CT)

→ SKETCH

Look at the Gothic Revival houses and sketch any details you would like into your notebook.

WEEK 11 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 23

Introducing Helena and Constantine

📖 Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ INTRO

What happens when a barmaid meets a lavishly dressed Roman officer named Flavius Constantius? A whirlwind romance, of course! It's not long before Helena and Flavius Constantius make things official, and Helena bears a child who is named Flavius Valerius Constantinus. The child becomes known as Emperor Constantine, the first Christian Emperor.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.17 p.297-310

- Discuss Constantine and Helena's relationship and how it influenced the Roman Empire.

→ LOCATE

📖 Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.14-15.
Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

WEEK 11 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 46

📖 Materials: Gold Mountain

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ INTRO

By 1861, an engineer named Theodore Judah had enlisted a group of investors in Sacramento to form the Central Pacific Railroad Company. He then headed to Washington, D.C., where he was able to convince congressional leaders, as well as President Lincoln, who signed the Pacific Railroad Act into law the following year. The Central Pacific Railroad Company would start building in Sacramento and continue east across the Sierra Nevada, while a second company, the Union Pacific Railroad, would build westward from the Missouri River, near the Iowa-Nebraska border.

The two lines of track would meet in the middle (the bill did not designate an exact location), and each company would receive 6,400 acres of land (later doubled to 12,800) and \$48,000 in government bonds for every mile of track built. From the beginning, then, the building of the transcontinental railroad was set up in terms of a competition between the two companies. (from history.com)

★ TEACHER NOTE

There are two curse words on p.74.

You may choose to skip the last paragraphs on p.82, since it refers to a woman's cycle.

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2	
→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS 1. p.74-81 "Descending the gangplank" - "they had come." (Skipping p.81-82 for the sake of time and content.) 2. p.83-86 "Payday was the" - "in her fist."	
WEEK 12 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 24 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Eiffel's Tower for Young People	
WEEK 12 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 47 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Abraham Lincoln and Frederick Douglass: The Story Behind an American Friendship	
WEEK 12 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 24 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: A Short History of Ancient Rome	
WEEK 12 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 48 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860	

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 1 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 25

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People, notebook

→ RECAP

Where are we at in the story?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.111-124 "On Sunday, March 31" - "to Theo's wife."

→ NOTEBOOK

Add information to your character list for Gustave Eiffel, James McNeill Whistler, Van Gogh brothers, Paul Gauguin.

• IMPORTANT DATES

1889 Eiffel Tower is completed

WEEK 1 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 49

Meeting Louis Hughes

Materials: A Year in the South: 1865

→ INTRO

In 1832, a baby boy was born around Charlottesville, Virginia. His name would be Louis Hughes, and he was the son of a black mother and a white father. Louis would marry, have children, and live through the events of the Civil War. In his old age, he would write a memoir, sharing his life story.

In *A Year in the South*, author and Civil War historian Stephen Ash uses Louis Hughes' memoir and other additional primary sources to detail one of the most eventful years in the history of the United States: 1865. This is the year that the Civil War would come to an end. But what did the victory of the Civil War mean for the men and women still enslaved in the South? When did freedom come? These are just a few of the questions Stephen Ash will answer in his book.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.19-28

- What surprised you in the reading?

• IMPORTANT DATES

Civil War ends on April 9th, 1865
Lincoln is assassinated on April 14th, 1865

WEEK 1 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 25

The Christian Revolution

Materials: The Witness of Early Christian Women: Mothers of the Church

→ INTRO

How revolutionary was Christianity in the Roman Empire? Jesus' teachings challenged a lot of different ideas that had come to be accepted as truths, such as the belief that women were inferior. Mike Aquilina writes, "Males were superior (a man would say) because women were inferior. It was obvious — so obvious that it hardly needed an argument. Fire is hot, water is wet, and women are inferior to men. This unquestioned and unquestionable truth was the basis of all human society."

So what happens when one of Christianity's most prolific writers challenges this idea in his letters? Think about Galatians 3:28, which reads, "There is neither Jew nor Greek, there is neither slave nor free, there is neither male nor female; for you are all one in Christ Jesus." Paul's words would have registered as an attack on Rome's family values. Paul promotes the idea that women have a place in society, a place in the Bible, and a place in the early church. As you read through this book, we encourage you to take note of anything that stands out, anything you agree with, and anything you disagree with.

★ TEACHER NOTE

Please preview the top of p.16 and you decide if you want to skip that paragraph which talks about the ill treatment of women.

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.1 p.13-26 end at "contemporaries took them."

- Discuss what ideas in the reading stood out to you? Why?

WEEK 1 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 50

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ INTRO

What kind of dangers do you think the railroad workers faced during the building of the transcontinental railroad?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.86-97 "Lin Fan stood" - "a lazy cook."

★ TEACHER NOTE

Note the curse word on p.96.

WEEK 2 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 26

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People, notebook

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. p.124-145 "In his laboratory" - "dramas, and amusements."
2. (Optional) Blue pages on p.132-133

→ NOTEBOOK

Add information to your character list for Thomas Edison, Buffalo Bill, Annie Oakley.

• IMPORTANT DATES

1889 Opening of Universal Exposition

• EXTRA HELPING

This video explains how the phonogram works.

∞ Video Link: Edison's Phonograph

WEEK 2 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 51

Meeting Cornelia McDonald

Materials: A Year in the South: 1865

→ INTRO

In the prologue of A Year in the South, Stephen Ash introduces his audience to Cornelia McDonald. He writes, "When 1865 began, Cornelia McDonald was forty-two years old and living in a rented house in Lexington, Virginia, with her seven children. She was a widow and a war refugee. The death of her husband, a Confederate army officer, and the loss of her home had brought her to the verge of poverty and despair." Cornelia McDonald was born in Virginia. She was born in 1822 to a well-off family. Her family had owned slaves, and she had grown up never needing to work with her hands. How does the victory of the Union in 1865 impact this young mother and widow? Author and Civil War historian Stephen Ash will use many different primary sources to piece together this young woman's story.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.29-37 stop at "all year round."

- What is something in Cornelia's story that you didn't expect to read?

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 2 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 26

Meeting Women in the Early Church

Materials: The Witness of Early Christian Women: Mothers of the Church

→ INTRO

At the beginning of this chapter, Mike Aquilina writes, "Jesus of Nazareth specialized in shocking the sensibilities of the religious establishment of his day. It was easy to do, because the establishment was easily shocked. Heal a blind man on the Sabbath, and you've turned the world upside down. But there was hardly anything more shocking than the way he treated women." In the next chapter, you will meet just some of the women in the New Testament who walked alongside Jesus and did ministry along with his disciples.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.2 p.27-35 "Jesus of Nazareth" - "its twelve apostles."

- What stood out to you about Mary in this section?

WEEK 2 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 52

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ NOTE

We are skipping Ch.10 for the sake of time.

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ INTRO

In Ch.10, Ling Fan starts her new job of cooking food for the crew. She assists Tan Din, and most of the people complain about the bad food.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.105-116 "For the next" - "mountain work camps."

→ VIEW

∞ Video: Stanford University Research

This section shows pictures of the tents where the workers slept. (34:48-36:55)

★ TEACHER NOTE

Note the curse word on p.111.

WEEK 3 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 27

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People, notebook

→RECAP

Summarize the previous reading.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.147-163 "In the first" - "her husband's death."

- Why do you think the people were interested in the Wild West Shows?
- How did the Wild West Show both represent and misrepresent the United States in 1889?

→ NOTEBOOK

Add information to your character list for Buffalo Bill, Annie Oakley, Gustave Eiffel.

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 3 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 53

Meeting Cornelia McDonald Continued...

Materials: A Year in the South: 1865

→ RECAP

Think back to where you left off?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.37-45 start at "when an opportunity" - end of chapter

- What stood out to you in the reading?

WEEK 3 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 27

Meeting Women in the Early Church

Materials: The Witness of Early Christian Women: Mothers of the Church

→ RECAP

What did you read last week? As you read through these sections, we encourage you to take note of the named women and their stories.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.35-46 "Throughout the ministry" - "in her life."

- What other women are missing in the section? Where do you find these women in the Bible?

★ TEACHER NOTE

You may want to discuss the ideas of celibacy mentioned on the bottom of p.45.

WEEK 3 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 54

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.117-127 "Storm's coming" - "that bonus money."

★ TEACHER NOTE

You may want to discuss opium, which is mentioned in this section.

WEEK 4 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 28

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People, notebook

→ NOTE

For the sake of time, we are skipping a few pages that talk about some issues with the elevators.

→ RECAP

Briefly recap the last reading.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. p.171-188 "Monday, June 10" - "dollar to invest."
2. (Optional) Blue pages p.182-183

- What section would you be most interested in visiting?
- Why do you think people weren't impressed with the American exhibits?

→ NOTEBOOK

Add information to your character list for Thomas Edison.

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 4 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 55

Cornelia McDonald In the Spring

Materials: A Year in the South: 1865

→ RECAP

Think back to where you left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.97-107

- War impacts everyone, but it does so in many different ways. What are some of the impacts on Cornelia, her family, and her town that you see in the reading?

WEEK 4 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 28

Thecla

Materials: The Witness of Early Christian Women: Mothers of the Church

→ INTRO

The story of Thecla was recalled in a text known as the Acts of Paul and Thecla. We have it in many different translations, and it recalls the life and conversion of Thecla, who later became known as a saint. Her story has been met by much incredulity and questions of credibility. Some of Thecla's story will be shared with you in the next chapter. As you read through it, what kind of questions do you have for Thecla?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.46-59 "The story of Thecla" - "in the house."

- What surprised you in this chapter? Do you agree with the reading? Why or why not?

• COMPOSITION

On p.48-59, you'll read Thecla's stories. Choose one of the stories and summarize it in your own words.

WEEK 4 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 56

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.128-143 "Now more than" - "to find out."

WEEK 5 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 29

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People, notebook

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. p.188-209 "Annie Oakley" - "AAA's bids."
2. (Optional) Blue pages p.196-197

→ NOTEBOOK

Add information to your character list for Annie Oakley, Buffalo Bill.

→ VIEW & READ

1. Here is an image of the painting that was up for auction at the

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

exposition.

∞ Image Link: Angelus by Millet

2. Read about the painting on p.206-207.

WEEK 5 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 57

Louis Hughes in the Spring

📄 Materials: A Year in the South: 1865

→ INTRO

Like many enslaved women and men, Louis Hughes had dreams of being free. He would run away a couple of times, and every time he received a punishment. His story highlights the evil that we must face as those who study history. Humans are capable of great evil towards each other. Sin is a part of the human experience, and we can trace it to every place and every time.

In his book, *Why Study History*, John Fea writes, "Indeed, anyone who studies the past realizes that there are no heroes in history. While people may perform heroic acts, all humans are tainted by sin and are susceptible to acting in ways that preference themselves over others and God. Historians understand, perhaps better than most, the reality of the pain, suffering, injustice, anger, and vice brought on by sin. In other words, they understand the tragic dimensions of life."

History reminds us of the inherent weakness in the human condition and the very real possibility that our fellow human beings are capable of horrendous things. This should humble us, for "there, but for the grace of God, go I." One day, there will be a new heaven and new earth where there will be no more death or mourning or crying or pain.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.109-118 stop at "and poultry alike."

- How does Louis Hughes' story tell you more about what's going on in his community?

• STUDENT TIP

Be sure to add some people, events, and drawings of artifacts to your book of centuries.

WEEK 5 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 29

Perpetua and Felicity

📄 Materials: The Witness of Early Christian Women: Mothers of the Church

→ INTRO

Perpetua lived in the time of Emperor Septimius Severus. Mike Aquilina wrote that Septimius Severus "wasn't persecuting Christians per se at the moment, but he had made it a capital crime for Roman citizens to become Jews or Christians." Perpetua was a noblewoman and was able to write and read. She converted to Christianity and was sentenced to die with her servant Felicity. Her story is different from other accounts because it was written by her own hand. As you read through it, what kind of questions do you have for Perpetua and Felicity?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.60-67 "Perpetua is almost" - "had willed it."

- What does their story reveal about the cost of discipleship?

★ TEACHER NOTE

This chapter is about martyrdom so you may want to preview the reading.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Perpetua and Felicity martyred in 203 AD

• STUDENT TIP

Be sure to add some people, events, and drawings of artifacts to your book of centuries. Mark potential items with a Post-it note as you read so you remember to find something when you sit down to work in your book.

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 5 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 58

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.143-156 "There were three" - "the base camp."

→ VIEW

∞ Video: Stanford University Research

A historian shows photographs of the work it took to lay tracks across mountains. (28:05-30:17)

WEEK 6 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 30

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People, notebook

→RECAP

What happened last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.209-228 "At about one" - "bed at daylight."

- How did the Fourth of July bring more friendship than competition between France and the U.S.?

→ VIEW

Whistler had received a gold medal for his painting.

∞ Image Link: Painting of Lady Archibald Campbell

→ NOTEBOOK

Add information to your character list for James McNeill Whistler.

WEEK 6 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 59

Louis Hughes in the Spring

Materials: A Year in the South: 1865

→ RECAP

Think back to where you left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.122-124 start at "With the war" - end of chapter

- What surprised you about Louis Hughes' story?

WEEK 6 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 30

St. Blandina

Materials: The Witness of Early Christian Women: Mothers of the Church

→ RECAP

What did you read last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.67-73 "Blandina was a slave" - "to wild beasts."

- Why are these stories of martyrdom from the early church important for us to read?

★ TEACHER NOTE
Note the descriptions of martyrdom on p.70-71.

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 6 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 60

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ NOTE

We are skipping Ch.16 for the sake of time.

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.172-174 "Snow!" - "into the mountain!"

p.175-187 "As it turned out" - "earnings to me."

→ VIEW

∞ Video: Stanford University Research

A historian shows photos of the tunnels that had to be created by the workers. (30:19-32:30)

WEEK 7 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 31

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People, notebook

→RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.228-249 "Right after the" - "the Persian King."

→ NOTEBOOK

Add information to your character list for Buffalo Bill and Annie Oakley.

WEEK 7 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 61

Louis Hughes in Summer

Materials: A Year in the South: 1865

→ INTRO

With the surrender of General Lee to Ulysses Grant on April 9th, 1865, and the Emancipation Proclamation, enslaved men and women waited for their freedom to come, as their enslavers did not seem keen on letting them go free without influence from the soldiers.

In June of 1865, Louis Hughes and his wife and children were still waiting for their freedom to come. They waited and waited for their freedom. How long did they have to wait? How long until they could leave the plantation and become free men and women?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.127-135 stop at "join the escape"

- What do you think it was like for people like Louis Hughes to have to wait for their freedom?

WEEK 7 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 31

St. Agnes

Materials: The Witness of Early Christian Women: Mothers of the Church

→ RECAP

What did you read last week?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview content on p.74-75 about the treatment of Christian women.

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.73-80 "Of all the ancient" - "subject of Hercules"

- How does the account of Agnes reveal the difference between the values of the Romans and values of Agnes and other devout Christians?

WEEK 7 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 62

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ INTRO

We are skipping a couple of pages. As you recall, Wong Wei found out that Ling Fan was a girl. He then stabbed her with a knife. It was a shallow wound, but she was in pain. That is where we pick up the story.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.189-205 "Ling Fang hauled" - "following her too."

WEEK 8 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 32

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People, notebook

→ RECAP

Summarize the previous reading.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. p.253-274 "The United States" - "entertain the crowd." (Skip p.249-253)
2. (Optional) Blue pages p.270-271

→ NOTEBOOK

Add information to your character list for Thomas Edison.

WEEK 8 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 63

Louis Hughes in Summer

Materials: A Year in the South: 1865

→ RECAP

Think back to where you left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.135-142 start at "they halted at" - end of chapter

WEEK 8 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 32

St. Agnes Continued...

Materials: The Witness of Early Christian Women: Mothers of the Church

→ RECAP

What did you read about last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.80-87 "Prudentius" - end of chapter

- You've met many women from many different stations who were

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

martyred for their faith. Which one stood out to you the most and why?

- How does the early church seem different from us today? In what ways is the early church the same?

WEEK 8 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 64

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.206-214 "Rumors rippled through" - "air, alive and safe."

WEEK 9 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 33

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People, notebook

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. p.275-285 "Thomas Edison had" - "La Champagne."
2. Skip p.287-297 (for the sake of time)
3. p.297-305 "The steamship La Champagne" - "events in history."
4. (Optional) Blue pages p.278

→ VIEW

During the Exposition, an artist painted this picture showing Thomas Edison with the phonograph.

∞ Image Link: Painting of Thomas Alva Edison

→ NOTEBOOK

Add information to your character list for Thomas Edison and Gustave Eiffel.

WEEK 9 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 65

Cornelia McDonald in Summer

Materials: A Year in the South: 1865

→ INTRO

Cornelia McDonald was impoverished. Her kids were too busy working to go to school, and even if she could make things work, she still couldn't afford to send them to school. The Civil War had left her a widow and a single mother, and now she found herself barely able to afford to eat and send her kids to school. How did this mother survive summer? How would she stay standing with everything against her? She was facing the uncertainty of life just as much as anyone else.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.157-166 stop at "demanded their surrender."

WEEK 9 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 33

The Poets and Thinkers

Materials: The Witness of Early Christian Women: Mothers of the Church

→ INTRO

Mike Aquilina writes at the beginning of the chapter, "There were a few pagan women who earned fame as poets or philosophers, but they were very few. We can't say that women were commonly poets and



Term 3

philosophers among the Christians either, but the number seems to have been significantly higher." In the next section, you'll learn about St. Macrina, St. Marcella, St. Paula, St. Eustochium, and St. Monica. All of these women were poets and thinkers. As you read through it, what kind of questions do you have for these women?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.89-101 "There were a few" - "to preserve it."

- How did the women in this chapter display characteristics that were unique for women at that time?
- What do you think about Macrina's argument against the atheists?

WEEK 9 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 66

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ INTRO

We skipped a couple of pages for the sake of time in the last chapter and the beginning of this one. After payday, Wong Wei snuck up on Ling Fan and put a knife to her throat and made her give him her hard-earned money. She knew that as long as Wong Wei had the power to expose her secret, she would be at his mercy. "The only way to free herself was to destroy the web and crush the spider."

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.218-226 "Late winter turned" - "her next job."

p.230-239 "A smoky haze" - "what I've started."

WEEK 10 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 34

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People, notebook

→RECAP

Summarize the previous reading.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. p.307-325 "The 1889 World's" - "change its mind."

2. (Optional) Blue pages p.316-318

→ NOTEBOOK

Add information to your character list for Gustave Eiffel, Van Gogh brothers, Gauguin, Whistler, Buffalo Bill.

★ TEACHER NOTE

Please preview the mention of suicide on p.310.

WEEK 10 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 67

Cornelia McDonald in Summer and Fall

Materials: A Year in the South: 1865

→ RECAP

Think back to where you left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.166-169 start at "although they were" - end of chapter

p.197-204 stop at "when Angus died."

- How did Cornelia's circumstances change in this reading?

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 10 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 34

Marcella and Paula

Materials: The Witness of Early Christian Women: Mothers of the Church

→ RECAP

What did you read about last week?

→ INTRO

In this chapter Jerome, the early church father is mentioned. He is known for translating the Hebrew and Greek Scriptures into Latin, the most widely used language at that time. This translation of the Bible is called the Latin Vulgate and was a critical part of the expansion of Christianity in the early centuries. Vulgate means "common or commonly known." He was the teacher of the Marcella who you will read about today.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.101-120 "Marcella herself was" - "and my readers." (For the sake of time, 7th-8th graders can stop at top of p.116 "at obscure points.")

- Do you think the women provided persuasive arguments for Marcella to come to the Holy Lands?
- Based on Jerome's letter, what characteristics or actions of Marcella do you admire and which ones do you find a bit strange?

WEEK 10 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 68

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.240-251

- Are you surprised that O'Brien was behind the "accidents"?

★ TEACHER NOTE

There are two curse words in this reading—p.247 & 250.

WEEK 11 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 35

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People, notebook

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. p.326-346 "Back in Europe" - end of book (Feel free to skip p.340-344 "The Newspaper Man and the War.")

- What character in this book did you find most interesting? Why?
2. (Optional) Blue page p.342

→ NOTEBOOK

Add information to your character list for Annie Oakley, Thomas Edison, Gustave Eiffel.

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 11 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 69

Cornelia McDonald and Louis Hughes in Fall

Materials: A Year in the South: 1865

→ INTRO

1865 was a year marked by many uncertainties. As men and women were freed from the bondage of slavery, they would need to find homes, jobs, and safe havens where they could relish their freedom. And households that had built their wealth on the backs of slaves would need to transition quickly to be able to sustain themselves. The year 1865 would be one of the most tumultuous years in the history of the United States, but the fight for freedom didn't end with the Emancipation Proclamation or the winning of the Civil War. The rest of the 1800s would be filled with a struggle for equality that was just beginning.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.204-217 start at "She sat down" - end of chapter

- Compare Cornelia McDonald's fall to Louis Hughes' fall.

WEEK 11 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 35

St. Monica

Materials: The Witness of Early Christian Women: Mothers of the Church

→ RECAP

What did you read about last week?

→ INTRO

Monica was the mother of Augustine of Hippo one of the greatest theologians of all time. Monica is acknowledged for her perseverance in prayer for the conversion of her son who became a Christian at 31 years of age after a life far from God.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.121-132 "It might seem" - "from the body."

- What stands out about the life and faith of Monica?

• IMPORTANT DATES

333-387 Monica (Augustine's mother)

WEEK 11 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 70

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.25-27 p.252-272

- Do you think there is any way Ling Fan can begin to describe her experience in America to her family?
- What are some lessons do you think she may have learned from her time working on the railroad?

WEEK 12 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3	
Questions will come from: Eiffel's Tower for Young People	
WEEK 12 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 71 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: A Year in the South: 1865	
WEEK 12 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 36 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: The Witness of Early Christian Women: Mothers of the Church	
WEEK 12 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 72 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Gold Mountain	

History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)

Examination

Term 1

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

- Describe one part of Sacajawea's journey that stood out to you.
- Tell what you know about the different groups of people and what their motivations were for moving west.

Ancient History: Grades 7-9

- From A Short History of Ancient Rome: How did the Roman Republic fall?
- From A Short History of Ancient Rome: Which of the emperors you read about had the most impact on Ancient Rome? Explain your answer with three examples of their accomplishments.

Term 2

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

- Why do you think Lincoln and Douglass had a unique bond, and how did they both fight against slavery?
- Tell about how women fought for equal rights. OR Tell what life was like in the cities and some of the issues that needed to be addressed with working and living conditions.

Ancient History: Grades 7-9

- From A Short History of Ancient Rome: How did conquered nations react to Rome? Use examples from the reading.
- From A Short History of Ancient Rome: What led to the decline of the Roman Empire?

Term 3

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

- You read about Louis Hughes' and Cornelia McDonald's lives in the year 1865, after the Civil War ended. Choose one of these people and summarize their lives. What were the big milestones they faced?
- Tell about the story of Ling Fan and what you learned about the Chinese workers who worked on the transcontinental railroad.

Ancient History: Grades 7-9

- The Witness of Early Christian Women: Choose a woman in the New Testament and explain how she benefited the church and how she maneuvered through a culture that devalued her.
- The Witness of Early Christian Women: Choose a woman from either the martyrs and heroines or poets and thinkers section and summarize her story.